GRADE 3

Curriculum Book

Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 3 - Curriculum Book

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Ten fully fleshed lessons spanning the year. *Each lesson passes the picks-up-Monday test: a 3rd-grade teacher with no prior prep should be able to read this Sunday night and teach it Monday morning. Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Differentiation notes are specific. Vocabulary is included for each lesson. Time blocks default to 45 minutes (one upper-elementary block) unless noted.*

Lessons are sampled across the year so the full arc is visible:

1. (Week 1) Cash V1 launch + Skills, Hobbies, Needs Web
2. (Week 4) Picking Your Capstone — Trio Roles
3. (Week 7) The Idea Web Becomes a Promise
4. (Week 10) Five Ideas From One Problem
5. (Week 14) Defending Your Pick — Opinion Writing With Reasons
6. (Week 19) Lemonade Math — Cost, Revenue, Profit
7. (Week 23) Logo and Name as Messages
8. (Week 28) Run-of-Day in 6 Steps
9. (Week 32) Honest or Misleading? — The Juice Sort
10. (Week 36) Capstone Day — Set Up the Stand

Where ideas come from

Skills, hobbies, needs - and the eyes to notice.

Lesson 1 — Skills, Hobbies, Needs Web (Week 1)

"You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?"

- CASH, GRADE 3

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 45 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Skills, hobbies, needs **Topic area:** Self-awareness · idea generation launch

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- List at least 3 skills, 3 hobbies, and 3 needs they notice — on a single Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web.
- Use the words *skill, hobby, need, customer* in one spoken sentence.
- Predict one business idea their web suggests.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Identify one's own skills and interests.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.3.1:** Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions.

Materials

- Cash Video #1 ("Skills, Hobbies, Needs") — ~2:45.
- One Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web template per student (3 circles labeled SKILLS, HOBBIES, NEEDS, with branches).
- Capstone Journal (notebook) per student.
- Chart paper for the class web.
- Markers or colored pencils.

Vocabulary

- **Skill** — something you can do, because you practiced or because it comes naturally.
- **Hobby** — something you choose to do for fun.
- **Need** — something somebody is missing or wishes was different.
- **Customer** — a person who would use what you make or do.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video + Class Skill Round (~10 min)

Play Cash Video #1. Pause when Cash asks the question on screen. Open the floor: "*One thing you can do that another kid in this class might not know how to do.*" Cold-call three students. Push past "*I don't have anything*" with a coaching prompt: "*Do you take care of a pet? Do you remember everyone's name? Do you know how to braid hair? Those are skills.*" Write three example skills on the chart.

2. Explore — Build the Class Web Together (~12 min)

Draw three big circles on chart paper: SKILLS, HOBBIES, NEEDS. As a class, fill three branches in each circle out loud. Skills: "*I can read chapter books. I can ride a bike. I can speak Spanish.*" Hobbies: "*I draw. I play soccer. I build with Legos.*" Needs: "*The library books always have ripped covers. Some kids forget their snack. Recess balls go missing.*" Stay concrete. Names off the chart — needs are about the situation, not a kid.

3. Explain — The Match (~5 min)

State the year's first big idea aloud: "*A business idea is a match. It matches something you can do, or something you love, to somebody who would be glad you did it.*" Show the example: "*I can speak Spanish + nobody on the team helps the new student → I could be a buddy translator at recess.*" Add to Vocabulary Spine: *skill, hobby, need, customer.*

4. Apply — Build Your Own Web (~13 min)

Hand out the Web template. Students fill 3+ entries in each circle. Confer with 6 students while others work. Coaching question: "*What is one thing you do almost every day that another kid might not?*" When most are at 5+ entries, stop the room and say: "*Now circle two ideas your web suggests. Don't worry if they sound little. Little is fine.*"

5. Close — One-Sentence Predict (~5 min)

Each student writes, in the Capstone Journal: "*My web makes me think a business idea for me could be _____.*" Two volunteers share. Cash voice closer: "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it? We will find out together.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide sentence frame: "*My skill is* ***_. My hobby is . A need I see is*** *__.*" Allow drawings on the web instead of words. Pair with a peer for the close share.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-print 5 example skills, 5 example hobbies, 5 example needs the student can underline rather than write. Voice-record the closing sentence if writing is slow. Web is okay to finish in next session.
- **Advanced:** Push for specificity. "'*I am good at reading*' *is a start. What kind of reading? For who?*" Have them write a second sentence: *who is the customer for this idea?*

Assessment

Formative: During the conferring, note which students struggle to name even one skill. Plan a 1:1 in Week 2 with those students. **Summative:** Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web becomes Capstone Checkpoint 1 (Week 8). Filed.

Closure

Pin the prediction sentence into the Capstone Journal. Tell students they will revisit it in Week 8 and again on Capstone Day.

Homework / Extension

Ask one grown-up at home: "*What is one skill you have that you didn't have when you were 8?*" Bring back the answer Tuesday.

Teacher notes

The most common stumble is the kid who insists "*I don't have skills.*" Have a backup list ready: caring for a pet, remembering names, listening when a sibling is upset, making people laugh, drawing from memory, knowing routines. Those count. Don't accept "*I have nothing.*"

Lesson 2 — Picking Your Capstone, Choosing Trio Roles (Week 4)

> TRY THIS
>
> **Spot it in the wild**
>
> Walk through your house. Find three things somebody made or sold. Write the name of one. Who do you think bought it, and why?

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (extended block) **Unit:** 1 — Skills, hobbies, needs **Topic area:** Team formation · ownership

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Name their trio's Capstone idea in one sentence.
- Pick one of four roles (CEO, designer, money keeper, sales) and describe what their role does.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA SL.3.1:** Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Cooperation in a small team.

Materials

- A teacher-curated list of "Capstone-friendly" categories (food, helper job, product, content/zine, service, event).
- Role cards: CEO · Designer · Money Keeper · Sales — with a kid-friendly description on each.
- Trio Charter sheet (provided): Trio name · Capstone idea · Roles · One rule we agree to follow.

Vocabulary

- **CEO** — the person who keeps everyone on track and makes the final call when the team is stuck.
- **Designer** — the person who makes things look right (logo, sign, the way the stand looks).
- **Money keeper** — the person who tracks cost, revenue, and profit.
- **Sales** — the person who talks to the customer and explains what the business does.

Procedure

1. Engage — What is a Trio? (~7 min)

Ask: "*Have you ever been on a team where one person did everything? How did that go?*" Two volunteers. Frame the trio: three students, four roles, one shared idea. (Yes, four roles in a trio of three — students often double up; one person can be CEO+sales early, then split later.)

2. Explore — Read the Role Cards (~10 min)

Pass out role cards. Students read all four out loud as a class. Ask: "*Which role sounds the most like you, and why?*" Pair-share for 3 minutes. Two volunteers share whole-group.

3. Explain — How a Trio Works (~5 min)

State the rule: "*Every role does something the others don't. Specializing is what lets a small team do real work.*" That sentence quietly hits C3 D2.Eco. 10.3-5 — specialization — at the level a 3rd grader can use.

4. Apply — Form Trios + Charter (~25 min)

Teacher forms trios (do not let students self-select; pre-plan based on social dynamics, mixed skill, ELL pairings). Each trio gets a Trio Charter. They have 25 minutes to:

1. Pick a Capstone idea from the list. Reasoning: trio members each share one skill from their Web; the idea should match at least two of the three.
2. Pick roles (every role gets a name; the fourth role doubles up on whoever is CEO or wants it).
3. Write one rule the trio agrees to follow. *("We listen before we say no." "Money keeper has the final say on numbers.")*

Confer with each trio at least once. Coaching question: "*Whose skill is this idea using? Whose hobby?*"

5. Close — Trio Read-Out (~13 min)

Each trio stands up and reads its charter aloud in 30 seconds. Class claps for the rule, not the idea. (Cash voice move: celebrate the move, not the win.) Charters go on the wall.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide role cards in a second language if available; allow first-language discussion in trio. Trio Charter can be drawn as much as written.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-assign student to a role that fits processing speed (designer for slow processors who like detail; sales for verbal-first students). Allow voice-recorded charter.
- **Advanced:** Push for a *backup plan* clause in the rule line. "*What does the trio do if one teammate is absent for two days?*"

Assessment

Formative: Watch which trios stall on roles vs. on the idea. Different problems, different coaching. **Summative:** Trio Charter is the first artifact for Capstone Checkpoint 1.

Closure

Hang charters on the wall. Tell students they own these charters all year. They can revise once at Week 19 if the trio decides to pivot.

Homework / Extension

Each trio member writes 2 sentences in the Capstone Journal: "*My role on the trio is* ***_. My job is to*** ***___***."

Teacher notes

The two failure modes here: (1) one strong personality picks the idea and the others nod along — break that with the "*whose skill, whose hobby*" coaching question; (2) the trio cannot land on an idea — give them three teacher-suggested ideas and say "*pick one of these for now; you can revise in Week 19.*"

Lesson 3 — The Idea Web Becomes a Promise (Week 7)

WORDS TO KNOW

Skill
Something you have practiced enough to be good at.

Hobby
Something you do for fun, on your own time.

Need
A problem somebody has that they want solved.

Customer
The person who pays - not the person you wish would pay.

Idea
A skill, a hobby, or a need turned into a way to help someone.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 45 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Skills, hobbies, needs **Topic area:** From idea to customer-facing sentence

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Take one circled idea from their Web and write a one-sentence promise: "*My business will help _ **by** ___.*"
- Identify their first hypothetical customer in one phrase.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.3.4:** Produce writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1:** Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize.

Materials

- The student's Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web from Lesson 1.
- Promise Sentence template (one half-page).
- A 3-foot strip of butcher paper labeled "Vague" on one end and "Specific" on the other.

Vocabulary

- **Promise** — what your business says it will do for the customer.
- **Specific** — said with details, not just a category.

Procedure

1. Engage — Vague vs. Specific Walk (~8 min)

Read 6 statements. Students walk to the spot on the line. "*My business helps kids.*" (Vague.) "*My business helps third-grade kids who lose their pencils, by renting them a pencil for a day.*" (Specific.) After 3 statements, ask one student at each end: "*What made it specific?*"

2. Explore — Look at My Web Again (~7 min)

Students get their Webs back. Re-read the two circled ideas. Pair-share: "*Which of your two ideas is the most specific? Why?*"

3. Explain — The Promise Sentence (~5 min)

Show the frame on the board:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*My business will help* **_ by** ___."

Show two examples: "*My business will help kids who forget their snack by selling pretzel cups for a quarter at recess.*" "*My business will help second graders who don't know the lunch routine by writing a short comic that explains it.*" Both are specific; both name a customer.

4. Apply — Write the Promise (~15 min)

Each student writes their own promise sentence. Confer with 8 students. Coaching question: "*Who exactly? Where do they hang out? When do they need this?*"

5. Close — Stand and Read (~10 min)

Trios meet, share their promise sentences. Each trio picks the most specific one and reads it to the class. Cash voice closer: "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*" Tell them: in Lesson 4 next unit, they'll generate five new ideas — but they'll come back to this Promise sentence in Week 18.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Use the frame as a fill-in. Allow drawing the customer alongside the sentence.
- **IEP/504:** Provide 2 model promises with blanks already partly filled. Allow voice recording.
- **Advanced:** Add a second sentence: "*I will know my customer wants this when* _____." (Plants Grade 4's reality-check seed.)

Assessment

Formative: Conferring notes on which students stay vague. **Summative:** Promise Sentence filed in Capstone Journal.

Closure

Promise Sentences go in the Capstone Journal facing the Web. Students can compare *what I thought in Week 1* with *what I think now* later in the year.

Homework / Extension

Ask one grown-up: "*If a kid offered this for $1, would you tell another grown-up about it? Why or why not?*" Write the answer down. (First taste of customer evidence.)

Teacher notes

Watch for the "*my business will help everyone*" trap. Push back gently: "*Everyone is a way to say nobody. Who's the first one?*"

Lesson 4 — Five Ideas From One Problem (Week 10)

> **MATH MOMENT**
>
> **Tally five**
>
> Ask five people: 'Would you buy this?' Tally yes and no with marks. Five marks each row. Did more say yes or no?

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 45 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Five ideas from one problem **Topic area:** Idea generation as a skill

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Generate at least 5 business ideas from a single problem prompt.
- Pick the most "real-sounding" idea and give one reason in writing.

Standards alignment

- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1:** Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.
- **CCSS-ELA W.3.1:** Write opinion pieces — students defend their picked idea.
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-2:** Use a basic decision-making process to make a choice.

Materials

- Cash Video #3 ("Five Ideas Beats One Idea").

- 5-Idea page template (one numbered column, plus a defense box at the bottom).
- A class problem prompt on chart paper. Default: "*Lots of kids forget to bring water bottles. They get thirsty by the end of recess.*"

Vocabulary

- **Brainstorm** — write down many ideas before judging any.
- **Real-sounding** — feels like a real kid could actually do it.
- **Defend** — say why you picked it, with a reason.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video (~5 min)

Play Cash V3. End on the still image: "*Five beats one. Every time.*"

2. Explore — Class Brainstorm (~10 min)

Read the prompt. Set the timer for 4 minutes. Class calls out ideas; teacher writes every one on chart paper, no judging. Then take 2 minutes to read them aloud. (Common ones: water bottle rental, water station, bring-a-water reminder note, water-fountain map, refillable bottle decorating service.)

3. Explain — What "Real-Sounding" Means (~5 min)

State the rule: "*Real-sounding means a kid in this room could actually try it next week.*" Eliminate two from the chart that fail ("*build a vending machine*" — fails; "*sell fancy bottled water from France*" — fails). Cross them out. Don't apologize. Cash voice move: name what doesn't work without making fun of who said it.

4. Apply — Solo 5-Idea Page (~17 min)

Each student gets a 5-Idea page. New problem prompt at the top: "*Lots of kids forget their library books on library day. The teacher has to send them back.*" Five numbered slots. Students fill all five. Then the defense box: "*I picked #_ **because** ___.*" Confer with 7–8 students.

5. Close — Trio Pick + Reason (~8 min)

In trios, each student reads their picked idea and reason. Trio votes one favorite. Trio reads to class. Class listens for *the reason,* not the idea — that is what gets clapped. Cash voice closer: "*Don't pick the loudest idea. Pick the one with the best reason.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Allow drawings as ideas (numbered). Sentence frame for defense: "*I picked* _ ***because*** ___."
- **IEP/504:** Pre-fill ideas 1 and 2 as models; student fills 3, 4, 5. Reduce to 3 ideas + defense if needed.
- **Advanced:** Push for 6+ ideas. Add a "kill list" — "*which two of your ideas are not real-sounding, and why?*" — to start premortem thinking.

Assessment

Formative: During trio share, listen for the *reasons.* Students who can't say a reason yet will need a 1:1 in Lesson 5. **Summative:** 5-Idea page is Capstone Checkpoint 2 (Week 18, second of two pages).

Closure

Pages filed. Cash voice closer above.

Homework / Extension

Trio meets once before next class to pick the trio's favorite 5-idea page. They will be defending it in Lesson 5.

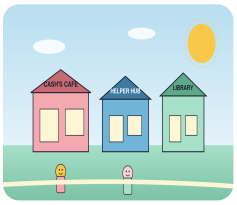
Teacher notes

The most common stumble: students freeze at idea 3. Coaching move: "*Make idea 3 a worse version of idea 1. Make idea 4 a sillier version. Make idea 5 the opposite of idea 1.*" Quantity is the goal in this lesson. Quality is Lesson 5's job.

Lesson 5 — Defending Your Pick (Week 14)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real customers

Family, neighbors, classmates, teachers, the person at the corner store. Five real people beats one good guess.

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 45 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Five ideas from one problem
Topic area: Opinion writing with reasons

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Write a 4-sentence opinion paragraph defending their picked idea.
- Use at least one of three reason types: *I have the skill / I see the need / Kids would actually use it.*

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.3.1:** Write opinion pieces on topics or texts, supporting a point of view with reasons.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognizing strengths.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize.

Materials

- The trio's chosen 5-idea page from Lesson 4.

- Defense Paragraph template: 4 lines labeled *Idea · Reason 1 · Reason 2 · So.*
- Three Reason-Type cards posted on the wall: I HAVE THE SKILL · I SEE THE NEED · KIDS WOULD ACTUALLY USE IT.

Vocabulary

- **Defend** (review).
- **Reason** — the *because* part. Why this idea, not another.

Procedure

1. Engage — Read a Bad Defense (~5 min)

Read aloud: "*I picked the water bottle rental because it's a good idea.*" Ask: "*What's wrong with that defense?*" Volunteers: "*There's no reason.*" Tell them: "*Today you're going to write a defense that has reasons.*"

2. Explore — Three Reason Types (~7 min)

Walk the room to the three Reason-Type cards. Read each. "*I have the skill*" — somebody on the trio can do this. "*I see the need*" — kids actually have this problem. "*Kids would actually use it*" — somebody would say yes if you offered it. The strongest defenses use 2 of 3.

3. Explain — The Frame (~5 min)

Show on the board:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*My idea is* ***_. My first reason is . My second reason is*** *__. So we pick this one.*"

Model with the water bottle prompt: "*My idea is the water bottle rental. My first reason is that I always have an extra bottle in my backpack — that's my skill. My second reason is that three kids on Monday asked me for water at recess — that's the need. So we pick this one.*"

4. Apply — Write the Defense (~20 min)

Each trio writes one defense paragraph for their chosen idea. CEO leads, but each member contributes one sentence. Money keeper writes; designer drafts a tiny supporting drawing in the margin. Confer with each trio.

5. Close — Defense Read + Class Sharpening (~8 min)

Two trios read. Class identifies which Reason Types they used. If only one Reason Type, class suggests a second. Cash voice closer: "*Most adults skip the reason. You won't.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide the frame as a fill-in. Allow trio to dictate while one member writes.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce to 3 sentences (drop second reason). Voice-record allowed.
- **Advanced:** Add a fourth sentence: "*One way I could be wrong is _____.*"

Assessment

Formative: Listen during read-out for which trios used 2 reason types vs. 1.
Summative: Defense paragraph filed with the 5-idea page; together they are Capstone Checkpoint 2.

Closure

Tell students: in Unit 3 they will check the math on their idea. "*Reasons are good. Numbers are better.*"

Homework / Extension

Trio meets to add a fourth sentence: "*One way we could be wrong is _____.*" (Premortem seed.)

Teacher notes

The opinion-writing standard (W.3.1) is hit cleanly here. If your school uses a writing rubric, this is a perfect place to double-dip.

Lesson 6 — Lemonade Math (Week 19)

FAMILY TALK

Skill, hobby, or need?

At dinner, name one skill, one hobby, and one need somebody at the table has. Could any of them turn into a tiny business?

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 60 minutes (extended block — math + write-up)
Unit: 3 — The lemonade math + the logo **Topic area:** Cost · revenue · profit

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Calculate cost, revenue, and profit for a lemonade-stand scenario with whole-number prices.
- Write one sentence explaining what *profit* means in their own words.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math 3.OA.D.8:** Solve two-step word problems using the four operations.
- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize.

Materials

- Cash Video #5 ("What's Left").
- Cost/Revenue/Profit worksheet (provided) — 5 scenarios, whole-number prices.
- Counters or play coins (optional, for concrete modeling).
- Anchor chart with three labeled boxes: COST · REVENUE · PROFIT.

Vocabulary

- **Cost** — what you paid to make or buy what you sell.
- **Revenue** — all the money you took in.
- **Profit** — what's left after you pay the cost. Revenue minus cost.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video + One Question (~7 min)

Play Cash V5. After: "*In your own words, what's profit?*" Two volunteers. Don't correct yet — Cash will define it in step 3.

2. Explore — Class Lemonade Stand (~15 min)

On the anchor chart: "*For a hypothetical lemonade stand: the can of mix costs $4. We poured 16 cups. We sold each cup for $1.*" Walk through it as a class:

- Cost = $4 (one number, the can).
- Revenue = 16 × $1 = $16 (multiplication, two-step word problem starts here).
- Profit = $16 − $4 = $12.

Write each step in the matching box. Use coins if you have them. Have a student come up and say it back: "*We made $12 of profit because $16 minus $4 is $12.*"

3. Explain — The Three Words (~5 min)

State the rule: "*Cost is what you pay. Revenue is what you take in. Profit is what's left.*" Add to Vocabulary Spine. Build the Frayer square for *profit* (definition · example · non-example · picture).

4. Apply — Worksheet + Write (~25 min)

Students do 5 scenarios on the worksheet. Examples:

- Scenario 2: cookies cost $3 to make, sold 10 for $1 each. Profit?
- Scenario 3: bracelets cost $6 of beads, sold 5 for $2 each. Profit?

- Scenario 4: dog-walking flyer cost $0 (paper from school), walked 4 dogs at $5 each. Profit?
- Scenario 5: zine cost $2 to print, sold 5 for $1 each. Profit?
- Scenario 6 (advanced): lemonade can $4, made 16 cups, only sold 8. Revenue? Profit?

Students write *one sentence* at the bottom: "*Profit means* _____."

5. Close — Trio Number Share (~8 min)

Each trio shares the profit number for their own Capstone idea, computed quickly. Money keeper does the math, sales says it aloud, designer writes it on a sticky note for the wall. Cash voice closer: "*Revenue is loud. Profit is true. Pay attention to what's left.*" (Bridge to Grade 7's *contribution margin* without using the words.)

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Picture-rich worksheet with cans, cups, dollar signs already drawn. Sentence frame for the close: "*Profit means* _____."
- **IEP/504:** Reduce to 3 scenarios. Provide a calculator for scenario 6. Allow concrete modeling with coins.
- **Advanced:** Scenario 6 is required. Add scenario 7: "*What if you raised the price to $2 but only sold 6 cups?*"

Assessment

Formative: Walk during work time, spot which students stall on multiplication (revenue) vs. subtraction (profit). **Summative:** Worksheet is part of Capstone Checkpoint 3 (Week 27).

Closure

Anchor chart stays up the rest of the year.

Homework / Extension

Trio computes profit for their own Capstone idea on a fresh worksheet. Bring back next class.

Teacher notes

Watch for the kid who insists "*profit is how much you sold.*" That is revenue, not profit. Use the coin demonstration: "*You took in $16. You paid $4 back to whoever sold you the can. The $12 left in your pocket — that's profit.*"

Lesson 7 — Logo and Name as Messages (Week 23)

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 45 minutes **Unit:** 3 — The lemonade math + the logo **Topic area:** Branding · message

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Draw a logo and choose a name for their Capstone business.
- Tell, in one sentence each, what the logo and the name communicate to a customer.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.3.4:** Produce writing appropriate to task and purpose.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1:** Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Identifying personal strengths.

Materials

- 4 example logo + name pairs printed: a sleepy moon for a bedtime book service; a smiling pretzel for a snack stand; a paw-print for a dog walker; a number 1 inside a circle for a tutoring service.
- Logo + Name worksheet (4-inch square + name line + two "what does this say to a customer" lines).
- Markers, colored pencils.

Vocabulary

- **Logo** — a small picture that stands for a business.
- **Name** — what your business is called.
- **Message** — what the logo and name tell a customer before you talk.

Procedure

1. Engage — Read the Logos (~10 min)

Hold up each example one at a time. "*What does this logo tell you about the business? Don't read the name yet.*" Students call out. Then reveal the names. "*Was the logo's message right? Was the name's message right?*"

2. Explore — Match Game (~7 min)

Pass out 6 mismatched logo–name pairs (a paw print + "Tasty Pretzels"). Trios discuss: "*Why doesn't this match? What would match better?*" Two trios share.

3. Explain — The Message Rule (~5 min)

State the rule: "*A logo and a name are messages. They tell the customer something before you say a word. Make them say the right thing.*" Add *logo, name, message* to Vocabulary Spine.

4. Apply — Trio Logo + Name (~15 min)

Designer leads, but everyone contributes. Trio fills the worksheet:

1. Name (one to three words).

2. Logo (drawn in the square; designer leads but every member adds a mark).
3. *What does the name tell a customer?* (one sentence).
4. *What does the logo tell a customer?* (one sentence).

Confer with each trio. Coaching question: "*If your customer saw this logo and didn't read the name, would they still know what you do?*"

5. Close — Wall Walk + One Compliment (~8 min)

All worksheets go on the wall. Class does a 4-minute silent gallery walk with sticky notes. Each student writes one compliment about the *message*, not the art, on one trio's logo. *("This logo says fast — I get it.")* Cash voice closer: "*You picked a message. Now make sure your customer hears it.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Allow native-language name with English subtitle. Sentence frame for the message lines.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-print 3 logo shapes (circle, square, star) the designer can adapt. Voice-record the message lines.
- **Advanced:** Pick two colors and explain what each color says. (Plants Grade 10's brand-guide unit.)

Assessment

Formative: Watch during gallery walk for which logos got "I get it" notes vs. which got blank stares. **Summative:** Logo + Name worksheet is part of Capstone Checkpoint 3.

Closure

Worksheets get filed in Capstone Journal. They will be re-examined on Capstone Day.

Homework / Extension

Each trio member shows the logo to one grown-up at home and asks: "*What do you think this business does?*" Bring the answers back. (Customer-evidence seed.)

Teacher notes

Avoid the trap of "*my logo is just a heart because I like hearts.*" Coaching move: "*Hearts say love. Does your business sell love?*" Push for a logo whose shape says something true about the work.

Lesson 8 — Run-of-Day in 6 Steps (Week 28)

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 45 minutes **Unit:** 4 — Run the day, tell the truth, fix the flop **Topic area:** Operations · sequencing

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- List the 4–6 steps of running their Capstone business in order.
- Identify what breaks if a step is skipped.

Standards alignment

- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2:** Generate and compare multiple possible solutions to a problem.
- **CCSS-ELA W.3.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Identifying problems.

Materials

- 6 large index cards per trio, each labeled with one verb on the front: OPEN · SELL · RESTOCK · CLOSE · COUNT · CLEAN.
- Run-of-Day strip (one numbered line, 6 boxes).

- A "What Went Wrong" prompt set: 4 short scenarios about a stand that skipped a step.

Vocabulary

- **Plan** — the steps you'll do, in order.
- **Step** — one part of the plan.

Procedure

1. Engage — Skip-the-Step Story (~5 min)

Read aloud a 60-second story: "*On Tuesday the lemonade trio opened. They sold 14 cups. They closed at recess. The next day the lemonade pitcher was sticky and gross because nobody cleaned it. The customers laughed and walked away.*" Ask: "*What step did they skip?*"

2. Explore — Order the Cards (~10 min)

Trios get the 6 cards (OPEN · SELL · RESTOCK · CLOSE · COUNT · CLEAN). Lay them out in order. Different trios will land on different orders. (RESTOCK during SELL is fine, for example.) Two trios share their order. Class debates one disagreement.

3. Explain — There Is No One Right Order (~5 min)

State the rule: "*Most businesses run something like Open → Sell → Close → Count → Clean. Some need Restock in the middle. Your trio's order should match your idea.*"

4. Apply — Write the Run-of-Day (~17 min)

Each trio writes their own Run-of-Day strip for their Capstone, in order, in 4–6 steps. Then they answer the "What Breaks" question for each step: "*If we skipped this step, _____ would break.*" Confer with each trio.

5. Close — Trio Read + One Test (~8 min)

Each trio reads their strip aloud. Class picks one trio at random and asks: "*What if you skipped step 3? What breaks?*" Trio answers. Cash voice closer: "*Plans are not fancy. Plans are written down.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Use the cards as the primary language; writing is secondary. One-word labels are okay.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce to 4 steps. Pre-print a model strip for Lemonade trios.
- **Advanced:** Add a "checkpoint" — "*How will you know step 3 is finished?*"

Assessment

Formative: Watch for the trio that picks an order that makes no sense for their idea. **Summative:** Run-of-Day strip is part of Capstone Checkpoint 4.

Closure

Strips go on the wall. They will be used on Capstone Day to actually set up the stand.

Homework / Extension

Each trio member walks through the steps mentally at home and writes one revision they'd suggest in tomorrow's huddle.

Teacher notes

Watch for the trio that copies the example exactly. Coaching: "*Your business is not lemonade. What's your version of restock?*"

Lesson 9 — Honest or Misleading? (Week 32)

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 45 minutes **Unit:** 4 — Run the day, tell the truth, fix the flop **Topic area:** Ethics · honest claims

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Sort 12 product claims into HONEST and MISLEADING piles, with a reason for each.
- Apply the sort to their own Capstone marketing words.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA SL.3.1:** Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Considering ethical responsibility.
- **C3 D2.Eco.4.3-5:** Explain why incentives vary between buyers and sellers.

Materials

- "Honest or Misleading" sort cards — 12 cards. Examples: "*100% juice*" (honest if it's 100%) · "*Juice drink*" (honest — a drink with juice in it) · "*All-natural*" on something with food coloring (misleading) · "*Best lemonade in school*" with no proof (misleading) · "*Sold 14 cups Tuesday*" (honest if it's true) · "*Everyone loves it*" (misleading — *everyone* is the tip-off) · "*Made with care*" (honest, low-info but not false) · "*World's #1*" (misleading) · "*Trusted by Mrs. Lee's class*" with permission (honest) · "*Free upgrade*" when there's no upgrade (misleading) · "*$1 a cup*" (honest) · "*Healthier than soda*" (misleading without proof).
- A "Class Honesty Wall": two columns, HONEST and MISLEADING.
- Each trio's Capstone logo + name + any tagline they're using.

Vocabulary

- **Honest** — true, supportable, you can show how you know.

- **Misleading** — sounds true but isn't, or hides part of the truth.

Procedure

1. Engage — The Juice Pair (~7 min)

Hold up two labels: "*100% juice*" and "*juice drink.*" Ask: "*What's the difference?*" Two volunteers. State: "*Both can be honest, if they tell the truth about what's in the bottle. The trick is when one says 100% juice and it actually has water and sugar.*"

2. Explore — Trio Sort (~12 min)

Each trio gets a set of 12 cards. Sort into HONEST and MISLEADING piles. For each MISLEADING card, write one reason on a sticky note. Confer with each trio.

3. Explain — The Tip-Offs (~5 min)

State three tip-offs:

1. The word *everyone* (or *nobody*).
2. A claim with no number to back it up.
3. A word that sounds healthy or fancy but doesn't actually mean anything specific.

Add *honest, misleading* to Vocabulary Spine.

4. Apply — Audit Your Own Words (~13 min)

Each trio looks at their own logo, name, and any tagline they've drafted. They run it through the three tip-offs. If anything fails, they revise. Confer with each trio.

5. Close — Pick Your Class Honesty Wall Card (~8 min)

Each trio picks one card from the sort and tapes it on the matching column of the Class Honesty Wall, with the trio's reason on a sticky next to it. Cash voice closer: "*Honest claims build long-term customers. Clever claims build short-term sales. You can choose which kind of business you're running.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Picture-supported cards (a juice carton image on the *100% juice* card). Sentence frame: "*This is misleading because* _____."
- **IEP/504:** Reduce to 6 cards. Pair students with a strong reader for the sort.
- **Advanced:** Find one real product label at home or in the classroom and bring it back tomorrow with a HONEST or MISLEADING tag — and a reason.

Assessment

Formative: Listen during the trio sort for the *reasons* — that's where ethical reasoning lives at this age. **Summative:** Trio's revised Capstone words are part of Capstone Checkpoint 4.

Closure

Honesty Wall stays up the rest of the year. Capstone Day will revisit it.

Homework / Extension

Find one product at home with a claim. Decide HONEST or MISLEADING. Write the reason in the Capstone Journal. (Sensitivity flag: do not ask about the product's price or what was paid.)

Teacher notes

This is the sensitivity-heavy lesson of the year. Two coaching moves: (1) avoid mocking real brands by name in front of the class; use the cards instead. (2) If a student's family uses a product the class flags as *misleading,* protect the student — the lesson is about the claim, not the household.

Lesson 10 — Capstone Day (Week 36)

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 75 minutes (extended block) **Unit:** 4 — Run the day, tell the truth, fix the flop **Topic area:** Capstone · public-facing artifact

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Set up their Capstone stand with the year's four artifacts: logo + name, cost/revenue/profit, run-of-day strip, first-try fix reflection.
- Deliver a 90-second pitch using the words *customer, problem, plan, profit.*

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.3.4:** Report on a topic with appropriate facts and details, speaking clearly at an understandable pace.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness + Relationship Skills:** Recognize personal strengths; cooperate as a team.

Materials

- Each trio's full Capstone Journal artifacts.
- A 3-foot table per trio.
- Sticky-dot voting feedback (each visitor gets 3 dots: "I would buy this," "I learned something," "Honest claim").
- Family Visit invitation (sent home Week 33).
- Optional: invite a guest classroom (Grade 4 ideally — for the cross-grade hook).

Vocabulary

- **Customer · problem · plan · profit** — anchor four reviewed.
- **First try** — the version you started with.
- **Fix** — the change you made.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash V8 Replay (~5 min)

Play Cash V8 ("First-Try Fix") as students set up tables. Reminder of the year's last big idea: first tries get something wrong; the fix makes you a real entrepreneur.

2. Setup (~15 min)

Each trio sets up: logo + name visible, cost/revenue/profit worksheet visible, run-of-day strip visible, first-try fix reflection visible. Designer arranges the table. Money keeper makes sure numbers are readable from 3 feet. Sales drafts the 90-second pitch on a notecard. CEO double-checks the artifact list.

3. Family + Guest-Class Visit (~30 min)

Visitors enter. Each visitor gets 3 sticky dots and a 1-page guide: "*At each stand, you can: (a) listen to the pitch, (b) ask one question, (c) leave one sticky dot if you would buy it, learned something, or saw an honest claim.*"

Sales delivers the 90-second pitch. CEO answers one question. Money keeper or designer adds detail. Trio rotates so each member gets a turn at one role per visit.

4. Trio Reflection (~15 min)

Visitors leave. Trios sit together and answer three questions in writing:

1. What is one thing our first try got wrong?
2. What was the fix?
3. What would we do differently if we ran the stand for real next month?

5. Close — Class Circle (~10 min)

Class sits in a circle. Each trio reads their answer to question 3 — only that one. Teacher closes: "*You are 8 and 9 years old. You designed a business idea, did the math, drew the logo, named the steps, told the truth, found the flop, and fixed it. Most adults skip parts of this. You didn't.*" Cash voice closer (the year's last line): "*Which people, and how do you know? You started learning that this year. Grade 4 is going to take it further. We'll see you there.*"

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Pitch can be delivered in two languages, English first. Native-language family members are encouraged to ask questions in their home language; trio can answer in either.
- **IEP/504:** Pitch can be a posted poster the visitor reads, with the student answering one question. Visitor count can be capped (4 visits max).
- **Advanced:** Add one extra artifact — a "*what we'd change for Year 2*" paragraph.

Assessment

Formative: Visitor sticky dots are an attendance-credit measure, not a real grade. **Summative:** All four checkpoint artifacts are scored using the elementary-band scaling of the Business Plan Rubric (4 criteria) plus the Reflection Writing Rubric. The trio reflection in step 4 is the LRCI evidence (*one thing first try got wrong, one fix*).

Closure

The year's last circle is the closure. End on Cash's line above.

Homework / Extension

None. The year is done. Trios take their journals home.

Teacher notes

Two failure modes to plan around: (1) families who can't visit during school hours — record the trio's pitch on phone and share via class platform. (2) Trios that fall apart at the last minute — pair them with a finished trio for the 90-second pitch; their stand stands on its own; the pitch is collaborative across trios. Cash voice rule: celebrate the move, not the win.

Cross-grade hooks (named explicitly)

- **From Grade 2:** the *Problem → Idea* card and the *fair to the customer* check directly become this year's Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web (Lesson 1) and the Honest or Misleading sort (Lesson 9).
- **To Grade 4:** the *5-question Reality Check* (Who buys? How much? How many? What does it cost me? What's left?) is exactly what Lessons 4, 5, and 6 set up. Grade 3's Capstone artifacts feed directly into Grade 4's 1-page plan template.

Strand coverage map

STRAND	LESSONS THAT CENTER IT
BAVC	1, 3
PSIG	4, 5
MFL	6, 10
CBM	3, 7
OSO	2, 8, 10
LTO	2, 5, 10
ESL	9
LRCI	10

Every strand is centered in at least one lesson. The full year (36 weeks) spreads each strand across multiple touch points; these 10 sampled lessons are the spine.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 3 deliberate practice and misconceptions

Worked examples (add to Lesson 6 — Lemonade Math)

The original lesson works one example at one volume. Add three at three volumes side-by-side, with the cost-revenue-profit pattern visible.

Worked example A — Lemonade at three volumes

Cost per cup: $0.30 (lemons, sugar, cup). Price: $1 per cup.

CUPS SOLD	REVENUE	COST	PROFIT
10	$10	$3	$7
25	$25	$7.50	$17.50
50	$50	$15	$35

Coach the pattern out loud: "*Sell more, cost goes up. Revenue goes up. Profit goes up. But profit is always revenue minus cost. Not just revenue.*"

Worked example B — Friendship bracelets at three volumes

Cost per bracelet: $0.34. Price: $1.

BRACELETS SOLD	REVENUE	COST	PROFIT
10	$10	$3.40	$6.60
20	$20	$6.80	$13.20
30	$30	$10.20	$19.80

Worked example C — Dog walks at three volumes (no per-walk variable cost)

Cost per walk: $0 (already have leash). Price: $5 per walk.

WALKS DONE	REVENUE	COST	PROFIT
3	$15	$0	$15
6	$30	$0	$30
12	$60	$0	$60

Important coaching: "*Some businesses have very small per-customer costs. Dog walking is one. The walker still has costs — time, weather, sometimes treats — but the cost per walk is close to zero. Profit and revenue are almost the same.*"

Common Misconceptions (Grade 3)

KID BELIEF	WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE	HOW TO COACH
"Profit is whatever's left in my hand at the end of the day."	Profit is revenue minus cost. If you "got the supplies free," you still have to count what they would cost.	"*If you ran this every Saturday, would you keep getting the supplies free? What would they cost? That's the cost.*"
"If I sell more, profit always goes up."	Profit goes up only if you sell more without raising costs more. (Most do at this age, so it works for now — but plant the seed.)	"*For a lemonade stand, more cups means more cost. The math still works. Profit is the leftover number.*"
"My logo has to be perfect."	A logo is a *message*. Clear beats fancy. The customer cares whether they understand it.	Show two logos: one beautiful and confusing, one ugly and clear. "*Which one would make you stop and look?*"
"Honesty is just for grown-ups."	Honest businesses earn customers who come back. "100% juice" and "juice drink" are not the same. The customer notices.	Read the labels of two real drinks side by side. "*Which one tells the truth?*"

Grade 3 advanced-learner extension — "the kid with the great idea but no skills yet"

For students who finish the Skills + Hobbies + Needs web fast: introduce a fourth column, "Skills I Could Build." A great idea sometimes points at a skill the student doesn't yet have. "*What would you have to learn to do this?*" This is the seed of self-development planning that returns at Grade 11.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Grade 3)

COMMON KID-BELIEF	REALITY	COACHING MOVE
"Profit is whatever I have in my hand at the end of the day."	Profit = Revenue − Cost. The cash in your hand might *include* money you owe back to whoever bought your supplies.	Walk through three lemonade days side by side: Day 1 (cost $5, revenue $12, profit $7); Day 2 (cost $5, revenue $4, profit −$1, ouch); Day 3 (cost $5, revenue $20, profit $15). The "money in your hand" is *not* profit until cost is subtracted.
"If lots of people walked by, the business is doing well."	Foot traffic is not sales. Many people walk by; few buy. The number that matters is *how many bought*, at *what price*.	Run a 5-minute lemonade simulation. Count walk-by (10) vs. buyers (3). Discuss the gap.
"A logo is just a picture."	A logo communicates *what the business does* and *who its for*. A logo of a dog tells you its for pet owners; a logo of a cupcake tells you its a bakery.	Show 6 logos with the names hidden. Have students guess what each business does. Discuss what cued the guess.
"If I dont have a special skill, I cant start a business."	Everyone has skills. Skills include: kindness, listening, drawing, singing, building, fixing, organizing, teaching, etc. The Skills/Hobbies/Needs web finds where your skills meet someones need.	Run the web for a student who says "I have no skills." With prompts, they will find 3 skills (always). Affirm.
"Honest means *boring*."	Honest claims build customers who come back. Hype builds customers who feel taken. Honest can also be specific and exciting (e.g., "made fresh today" instead of "the BEST cookies EVER").	Show two ad pairs. Ask: "Which one would you trust? Which one is hype?"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Worked Examples for Lemonade Math (Lesson 6)

Lemonade scenario: lemons cost $3, sugar costs $1, cups cost $1. Total cost = $5. Sells for $1 per cup.

Worked Example 1 (low volume). Sold 4 cups. Revenue = 4 × $1 = $4. Profit = $4 − $5 = −$1 (loss). Coaching: "We sold *under cost*. Either drop costs, raise the price, or sell more cups."

Worked Example 2 (medium volume). Sold 8 cups. Revenue = 8 × $1 = $8. Profit = $8 − $5 = $3. Coaching: "We made $3. That covered cost and left us $3."

Worked Example 3 (high volume). Sold 20 cups. Revenue = 20 × $1 = $20. Profit = $20 − $5 = $15. Coaching: "Selling more cups *amplifies* profit because cost stays the same. This is the lesson of *fixed cost*."

Anti-example (most-common error). Student writes: Revenue = 8 × $1 = $8. Profit = $8 (forgot to subtract cost). Coaching: "What did the lemons cost? You havent paid the lemons back yet. The lemons came out of *your* pocket. Subtract them."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Multi-Class Branching Scenario (Grade 3)

"Mayas friendship bracelets — charge or trade?" A 3-day branching scenario.

- **Day 1.** Maya makes friendship bracelets. She has 20. The class brainstorms: should she *sell them for cents* or *trade them for things she wants* (snacks, stickers, time on the swing)? Generate 5 ideas total. Vote.
- **Day 2.** Trio teams design either the pricing (CEO + designer + money keeper) or the trade rules. CEO presents.

- **Day 3.** Run the bracelet exchange for 15 minutes. Money or trade — whichever the class chose. End with a debrief: "What worked? What flopped? What would Maya do differently?"

This branching practices Skills/Hobbies/Needs (Maya makes), CBM (logo + name), MFL (cost/revenue/profit if sold), LTO (3-person trio), ESL (honest pricing), LRCI (debrief).

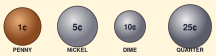
ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Grade 3)

- **Student says "my profit is whats in my hand."** Say: "Lets check the cost. What did the lemons cost? Lets subtract." Walk through it. Repeat: "Profit equals revenue minus cost."
- **Student says "I dont have any skills."** Say: "Everyone has skills. Lets find three. Are you kind? Do you listen? Can you draw a circle? You have skills. Lets put them on the web."
- **Student picks an idea no one would buy ("a service that licks ice cream for you").** Say: "Lets check — would you pay for that? Would your friends? If no, lets pick a different idea where someone *would* pay." Use the 5-question Reality Check seed.
- **Student picks a logo thats a unicorn for a babysitting business.** Say: "What does the unicorn tell the customer? Does it tell them you babysit? Lets pick something that *says* what you do."
- **Trio team has one student doing all the work.** Say: "Each role is real. CEO sets direction. Designer makes the look. Money keeper counts. Sales talks to customers. Lets check who has done what so far. Whose role is empty?"

FROM CASH

What I do, what I love, what I notice

Three questions. Three sentences. Three ideas. That's how a business starts - not with a logo, with a list.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 3 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Spending and saving - earning money, choices, opportunity cost.

CEE NS3
Productive resources, scarcity, and choice.

CCSS-MATH 3.MD
Measurement and data - survey customers, tally results.

CCSS-ELA SL.3.1
Engage in collaborative discussions - pitch and feedback.

CASEL Self-Awareness
Identify strengths, interests, and values.

C3 D2.Eco.1.3-5
Compare benefits and costs of choices.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it? — Cash

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